

1. Purpose

Darjo Community Alliance (Darjo) is committed to protecting the privacy, dignity, and confidentiality of the people we support, their families, representatives, and our partners. We recognise that personal and sensitive information must be handled responsibly and securely.

This Privacy Policy explains how Darjo collects, uses, stores, protects, and discloses personal information in accordance with Australian privacy laws, including the Privacy Act 1988 and the Australian Privacy Principles administered by the Office of the Australian Information Commissioner.

This policy applies to information collected through:

- our website.
- online enquiry and intake forms.
- referrals and service requests.
- service delivery and care coordination.
- phone, email, and written communications.
- meetings and consultations.
- third-party referrals and authorised representatives.

2. Who We Are

Darjo provides services including:

- aged care support.
- community-based services.
- care coordination.
- compliance and advisory services.
- service navigation and referrals.

To provide these services safely and effectively, we may collect personal and sensitive information necessary to understand a person's circumstances, assess needs, and coordinate appropriate support.

We are committed to ensuring that all personal information is handled respectfully, securely, and transparently.

3. What Information We Collect

Personal Information

We may collect personal information such as:

- full name and preferred name.
- date of birth.
- contact details (address, phone number, email).
- emergency contacts and next of kin.
- representative, guardian, or decision-maker details.
- referral information.
- government program identifiers (where required).
- service history and service preferences.
- communication preferences.

We aim to collect only the information that is reasonably necessary to deliver services and meet legal or operational obligations.

Sensitive Information

Due to the nature of aged care and community services, we may collect sensitive information including:

- health conditions and medical information.
- disability or functional support needs.
- mobility or cognitive support needs.
- cultural, linguistic, or spiritual considerations.
- risk or safety information.
- information relevant to care planning.
- social and wellbeing information related to support needs.

Sensitive information will only be collected where it is reasonably necessary for service delivery and with consent, unless otherwise permitted or required by law.

4. How We Collect Information

We collect personal information through a variety of methods, including:

- online forms submitted through our website
- intake and assessment processes.
- referrals from hospitals, health professionals, or service providers.
- government programs and referral pathways.
- phone conversations.
- emails and written correspondence.
- meetings, consultations, and service planning discussions.
- authorised representatives such as family members or guardians.

Where possible, we collect information directly from the individual concerned.

However, in some circumstances we may collect information from:

- authorised representatives.
- health professionals.
- service providers involved in care.
- publicly available sources.
- government agencies.

5. Why We Collect Personal Information

Darjo Community Alliance collects and uses personal information to:

- respond to enquiries and service requests.
- assess eligibility for services.
- provide aged care and community support services.
- coordinate supports with other providers.
- develop care or service plans.
- ensure safety and wellbeing of clients.
- communicate with individuals, families, and representatives.
- comply with legal, contractual, and regulatory obligations.
- meet reporting requirements for government-funded services.
- improve our services and quality systems.
- manage incidents, complaints, and feedback.
- support organisational governance and compliance activities.

If personal information is not provided, we may be unable to deliver services safely or effectively.

6. Consent

Darjo respects the importance of informed consent.

By providing personal information to us, you consent to the collection, use, and disclosure of your information as outlined in this policy.

Where sensitive information is collected, we will seek explicit consent where required.

Consent may be obtained through:

- online forms.
- written agreements.
- verbal confirmation.
- electronic acknowledgement.

If information is provided on behalf of another person, the individual providing the information must confirm they are authorised to do so.

Where appropriate, individuals may withdraw consent, subject to legal and service delivery requirements.

7. Disclosure of Personal Information

We may disclose personal information where necessary to deliver services, coordinate care, or meet legal obligations.

Information may be shared with:

- healthcare professionals.
- aged care providers.
- support workers and service partners.
- allied health professionals.
- government departments or regulatory bodies.
- referral organisations.

- case managers or coordinators.
- technology and secure system providers.

We only share information that is reasonably necessary and take reasonable steps to ensure that organisations receiving information protect it appropriately.

Information may also be disclosed where required by law, such as in response to legal requests, safeguarding concerns, or regulatory obligations.

8. Storage and Security of Information

Darjo takes reasonable steps to protect personal information from misuse, interference, loss, unauthorised access, modification, or disclosure.

Our security measures may include:

- secure digital systems and platforms.
- encrypted data transmission.
- secure hosting environments.
- restricted access controls.
- staff confidentiality obligations.
- password and authentication protections.
- regular monitoring and system security practices.
- secure document storage.
- controlled access to records.

Only authorised personnel who require access to perform their role are permitted to access personal information.

Staff and contractors are required to follow privacy and confidentiality requirements as part of their engagement with Darjo Community Alliance.

9. Data Breach and Incident Management

Darjo takes data protection seriously.

If a data breach occurs that is likely to result in serious harm, we will:

- assess and contain the breach.

- investigate the incident.
- notify affected individuals where required.
- report to relevant authorities if necessary.
- take steps to prevent recurrence.

We maintain internal processes to manage and respond to privacy incidents and data breaches.

10. Website Data and Online Forms

When information is submitted through our website:

- data is transmitted securely using encryption.
- only necessary information is requested.
- form submissions are stored in secure systems.
- access to submissions is restricted.

Our website may collect limited technical data such as:

- IP address.
- browser type.
- device information.
- pages visited.
- date and time of website access.

This information is used to:

- improve website functionality.
- maintain security.
- analyse website usage.
- detect misuse or technical issues.

11. Cookies and Website Analytics

Our website may use cookies or similar technologies to enhance the user experience.

Cookies may be used to:

- remember website preferences.
- improve performance.
- analyse website traffic.

Users may adjust their browser settings to refuse cookies if they prefer.

12. Access to and Correction of Information

Individuals have the right to access personal information held about them and request corrections if information is inaccurate, incomplete, or outdated.

Requests for access or correction can be made by contacting DarJo Community Solutions.

We will:

- verify identity where necessary.
- respond within a reasonable timeframe.
- provide access unless an exception under privacy law applies.

13. Withdrawing Consent

Individuals may withdraw consent for the use or disclosure of their personal information at any time.

However, this may affect our ability to:

- provide services.
- coordinate care.
- meet regulatory obligations.

14. Data Retention

Darjo retains personal information only for as long as necessary to:

- deliver services.
- comply with legal and regulatory requirements.
- manage complaints or disputes.

- support organisational record keeping.

When information is no longer required, we take reasonable steps to:

- securely destroy records, or
- de-identify personal information.

15. Overseas Disclosure

Some technology providers used by Darjo Community Alliance may store information on secure servers located outside Australia.

Where this occurs, we take reasonable steps to ensure that:

- privacy protections are in place.
- providers comply with privacy and security standards.
- data is handled appropriately.

16. Alignment with Aged Care Quality Standards

Darjo is committed to operating in a manner consistent with recognised aged care governance and quality frameworks.

Our privacy practices support quality service delivery by ensuring:

- information is handled respectfully and confidentially.
- clients are informed about how their information is used.
- consent is obtained and documented.
- information supports safe and effective care planning.
- privacy risks are managed through governance processes.

Protecting personal information is an important part of providing safe, person-centred services.

17. Client Rights, Dignity, and Confidentiality

Darjo recognises that privacy is closely linked to dignity, respect, and the rights of individuals receiving care.

We aim to ensure that:

- individuals are treated with respect and sensitivity.
- personal information is only accessed by authorised staff.
- clients are informed about how their information is used.
- cultural and personal preferences are respected.
- individuals can ask questions about privacy at any time.
- confidentiality is maintained during service delivery.

All staff and contractors are expected to maintain strict confidentiality regarding client information.

18. Complaints and Privacy Concerns

Darjo takes privacy concerns seriously.

If you believe your privacy has been breached, you may contact us to lodge a complaint.

We will:

- acknowledge your complaint.
- investigate the matter.
- respond within a reasonable timeframe.
- work with you to resolve the issue.

If you are not satisfied with our response, you may contact the Office of the Australian Information Commissioner.

19. Contact Us

For privacy enquiries, access requests, suspected data breaches or complaints:

Darjo Community Alliance

Email: admin@darjo.com.au

20. Updates to This Policy

We may update this Privacy Policy from time to time to reflect changes in our services, technology, or legal obligations.

The latest version will always be available on our website.

We encourage individuals to review this policy periodically.